Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

Arrival check

Look at your relief panel from Week 3. When you prop it upright and step back two metres, which part is clearest and which part fades away?

[ ] The chrome foil ridges catch the light, while some dark card beams blend into the dark base

[ ] The main arch is strong, but one corner feels empty and unbalanced

[ ] The texture is bold, and one higher layer at the focal joint will lock it together

Starter visual cues

Step 1 (Audit): Check your panel against Balance, Relief depth (3 levels), and Contrast (7:1 dark-to-light).

Step 2 (Swatch test): Try your proposed fix on a small 6 cm scrap tile first.

Step 3 (Apply): Once the swatch proves the fix works, add it cleanly to your main panel.

Record the 'Before -> Fix -> After' note in your studio log.

Vote: Why do professional studio makers test a new paint mix or foil texture on a small scrap swatch before putting it straight onto their main piece?

Studio practice planner

Select your audit target, swatch test, and panel upgrade.

Shapes/Focus: Target: boost focal joint, Target: separate dark pillar, Target: balance empty corner, Target: deepen recess shadow

Tools/Methods: Swatch: foil + ink wipe, Swatch: double lamination, Swatch: chalk flange edge, Swatch: oxide + chrome skim

Exit ticket

Why do we keep and mount our small test swatch in our studio log?

[ ] It provides visual evidence of how we tested and solved a design problem before altering the main piece

[ ] Because we ran out of backing card

[ ] To cover up our writing